Yutong Zhou
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Paris, France

EDUCATION

École Normale Supérieure-PSL, Paris, Île-de-France
Master's degree in Cognitive Science, expected 2027
M1 average: 16.95/20; 64 ECTS completed

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
B.A. in Cognitive Science; Minors in Computer Science and Media Arts and Design, conferred June 2025
Cumulative GPA: 3.88/4.00
Honors: The Dean's List (2021-2024)
Robert Maynard Hutchins Scholar (2021-2023)
Elected to Beta of Illinois Chapter of Phi Beta Kappa
Cum Laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Grounded conceptual representation; computational models of meaning and semantic generalization; spatial and event concepts; lexical semantic extension, colexification, and semantic typology; language and embodied cognition.

PUBLICATIONS

Zhou, Yutong. "Multi-lingual Transfer Learning for Intent Classification." *Proceedings of the 2021 3rd International Conference on Natural Language Processing (ICNLP)*, IEEE, 2021, pp. 168–173. https://doi.org/10.1109/ICNLP52887.2021.00034.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Zhou, Yutong, and Ming Xiang. "Separating Bilingual Exposure and Production in Cumulative Structural Priming: Evidence from Mandarin Dative Production." Manuscript in preparation.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Laboratoire de Sciences Cognitives et Psycholinguistique / Institut Jean Nicod
Research Intern, supervised by Yair Lakretz and Philippe Schlenker *June 2026 – Present*

- Developing a project comparing human and vision-language model reasoning over multimodal semantic and pragmatic inferences
- Testing models on animations, gestures, and emoji and comparing their responses with human judgments
- Developing pipelines for stimulus processing, model prompting, and quantitative analysis

Laboratoire de Sciences Cognitives et Psycholinguistique *February 2026 – June 2026*
Research Intern, supervised by Dr. Sho Tsuji

- Developed an asynchronous online paradigm for testing infant phonological discrimination on Lookit
- Built a gaze-data preprocessing and analysis pipeline for webcam-based looking-time data

The Language Processing Lab *October 2023 – June 2025*

Research Assistant, supervised by Prof. Ming Xiang

- Processed English and Chinese corpora using Python
- Created web-based experiment pages in HTML and JavaScript
- Conducted a psycholinguistic experiment on the influence of English exposure on Mandarin sentence production in bilingual speakers, supported by a Quad Undergraduate Research Grant
- Preparing a manuscript based on the project

ViaX *March 2020 – January 2021*

Researcher, supervised by Dr. Zihao Wang

- Built CNN-based intent classification models with BPE embeddings for English, Spanish, and Thai
- Compared monolingual, language-agnostic joint, and zero-shot transfer learning setups
- Analyzed transfer performance and embedding visualizations in relation to cross-linguistic similarity

Horizon Academic *August 2020 – September 2020*

Researcher, supervised by Dr. Parsa Akbari

- Wrote a research paper comparing reinforcement learning models in a bipedal walker environment.

SKILLS

Programming: Python; JavaScript/HTML/CSS; R
Research methods: Behavioral experiment programming; corpus processing; gaze-data preprocessing and analysis; statistical analysis; basic NLP methods; experimental stimulus design and illustration
Tools: Git/GitHub; LaTeX; Lookit / Children Helping Science
Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent); French, Japanese, and Cantonese (intermediate); Irish and German (elementary)

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Embodied LoT *June 2023 – Present*

- Developed a probabilistic concept-learning model using a compositional Language of Thought and Metropolis–Hastings inference over structured visual events
- Implemented program generation, event rendering, inference, and visualization tools
- Link: https://github.com/TonyYZ/Embodied-LoT

Language Iconicity *December 2021, January 2023 – March 2023*

- Built a multilingual dataset for basic vocabulary (~2000 words) in 22 languages
- Developed phoneme-based word representations and cross-linguistic vector-space analyses of phonetic–semantic correspondences
- Link: https://github.com/TonyYZ/Nguasach

Experimental Symbolic System *March 2022 – Present*

- Designed a constructed language (Ítí) inspired by *Yijing* trigrams
- Developed the parser and drawer for the language as a digital artwork
- Developed a web-based communication game to test its learnability
- Link: https://github.com/TonyYZ/Ete, www.ukiriz.com/canvas.html

Etymism (WeChat and RedNote Accounts) *July 2020 – Present*

- Wrote articles on cross-linguistic etymology, semantics, and lexical connections
- Introduced the linguistic structure and artistic design principles of the constructed language Ítí
- Described the communication game and recruited participants

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Chinese Language Program, University of Chicago *January 2025 – June 2025*

Language Assistant

- Facilitated oral practice and cultural discussion for second-year Chinese students
- Helped professors evaluate students' progress and efforts

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

French Club, University of Chicago *August 2023 – June 2025*

Operations Coordinator

- Facilitated team meetings and communication
- Purchased refreshments and prepared activity materials
- Oversaw weekly language tables and other activities

Mexicayollotl, University of Chicago *November 2024 – June 2025*

Entertainment Coordinator, Nahuatl Study Group

- Mentored students by explaining difficult grammatical and lexical points and comparing Nahuatl with other languages
- Provided long-term support to the language group and invited new people to join